

Azure Portal Navigation

Get comfortable with the Portal layout before your first lab

 Beginner

 8 Minutes

 AZ-104 · Prerequisites

Why This Matters

Every lab in this course is written for the Azure Portal at portal.azure.com. If you've never used it before, a few minutes learning the layout will make every lab's instructions much faster to follow.

The Basics

- **Search bar** (top of every page): the fastest way to get anywhere. Type a service name (e.g., "Virtual machines", "Resource groups") and select it from the results. Every lab in this course starts with "Search for **<service>**" — this is what that means.
- **Blade**: the Portal's term for a panel/page. Clicking into a resource opens its "blade," which has a left-hand menu of sections (Overview, Settings, Monitoring, etc.).
- **+ Create**: the button to start creating a new resource. Creation wizards are organized into **tabs** (Basics, Networking, Management, Tags, Review + create) — labs reference these by tab name.
- **Review + create**: the final tab of almost every creation wizard. Azure validates your configuration here before letting you click **Create**.

Resource Groups

A **resource group** is a logical container for related resources. Nearly every lab's first step is creating a resource group (named `rg-az104-labXX` by convention), and the last step ("Cleanup") is deleting it — which deletes everything inside it in one action. This keeps costs predictable: if you forget anything else, deleting the resource group cleans it up.

```
rg-az104-lab01
```

```
|— Virtual Network
```

```
|— Network Security Group
```

```
|— Virtual Machine
```

```
|— Public IP Address
```

Cleanup step:

Delete resource group "rg-az104-lab01"

```
|— Removes everything above  
    in a single action ✓
```

Useful Portal Features Used Throughout This Course

- **Resource groups > <name> > Overview:** shows all resources in the group — useful for confirming what you've created so far.
- **All resources:** a flat view of everything in your subscription, filterable by resource group, type, or location.
- **Notifications** (bell icon, top right): shows deployment progress — useful when a "Create" action takes a few minutes (e.g., VMs, gateways).
- **Cloud Shell** (terminal icon, top right): gives you a browser-based CLI. **Not used in this course** — every lab is deliberately Portal-only — but worth knowing it exists, since some Microsoft Learn docs default to it.

Cost Awareness

The Portal shows estimated costs in some creation wizards (e.g., VM size selection shows an hourly estimate). Combined with the **Cost tip** repeated throughout this course — always run each lab's **Cleanup** section — this is enough to keep a free/trial subscription's spend near zero.

How This Connects to Other Topics

Cloud Computing Fundamentals

Resource groups sit at the bottom of the **resource hierarchy** (Management Group → Subscription → Resource Group → Resource).

Module 01 — Identity & Governance

This is the first hands-on module — **Entra ID Overview** is where Lab 01 begins.

Key Takeaways

Summary

- **Search bar** = fastest way to find any service
- **Blade** = a resource's panel with a left-hand section menu
- **+ Create** wizards are organized into **tabs**, ending with **Review + create**
- **Resource group** = logical container; delete it to clean up everything inside
- **Notifications** (bell) track deployment progress
- **Cloud Shell** exists but isn't used in this course (Portal-only labs)
- Always run each lab's **Cleanup** step to keep costs near zero

Next Steps

1. **Recap:** Read **Cloud Computing Fundamentals** if you haven't yet
2. **Recap:** Read **Identity & Access Fundamentals** if you haven't yet
3. **Begin:** **Module 01: Entra ID Overview** — your first hands-on module

Azure AZ-104	Module	Generated
Professional Concept Documentation	00 — Prerequisites	June 15, 2026

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